Use a Different PHP Version

In many cases, you might want to use XAMPP with a different PHP version than the one that comes pre-installed. You might do this to get the benefits of a newer version of PHP, or to reproduce bugs using an earlier version of PHP.

To use a different version of PHP with XAMPP, follow these steps:

1. Download a binary build of the PHP version that you wish to use from the PHP website, and extract the contents of the compressed archive file to your XAMPP installation directory (usually, *C:\xampp*). Ensure that you give it a different directory name to avoid overwriting the existing PHP version. For example, in this tutorial, we'll call the new directory *C:\xampp\php5-6-0*.

   NOTE Ensure that the PHP build you download matches the Apache build (VC9 or VC11) in your XAMPP platform.

2. Within the new directory, rename the *php.ini-development* file to *php.ini*. If you prefer to use production settings, you could instead rename the *php.ini-production* file to *php.ini*.

3. Edit the *httpd-xampp.conf* file in the *apache\conf\extra* subdirectory of your XAMPP installation directory. Within this file, search for all instances of the old PHP directory path and replace them with the path to the new PHP directory created in Step 1.

   In particular, be sure to change the lines

   ```
   LoadFile "/xampp/php/php5ts.dll"
   LoadFile "/xampp/php/libpq.dll"
   LoadModule php5_module "/xampp/php/php5apache2_4.dll"
   ```

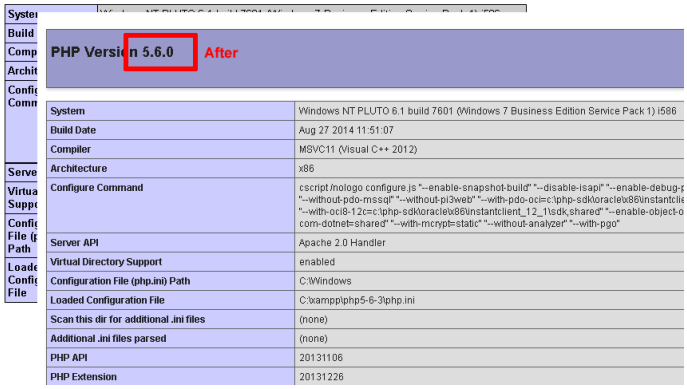
   to

   ```
   LoadFile "/xampp/php5-6-0/php5ts.dll"
   LoadFile "/xampp/php5-6-0/libpq.dll"
   LoadModule php5_module "/xampp/php5-6-0/php5apache2_4.dll"
   ```

   NOTE Remember to adjust the file and directory paths above to reflect valid paths on your system.

4. Restart your Apache server through the XAMPP control panel for your changes to take effect.

The new version of PHP should now be active. To verify this, browse to the URL http://localhost/xampp/phpinfo.php, which displays the output of the *phpinfo()* command, and check the version number at the top of the page.



System	Windows NT PLUTO 6.1 build 7601 (Windows 7 Business Edition Service Pack 1) i586
Build Date	Aug 27 2014 11:51:07
Compiler	MSVC11 (Visual C++ 2012)
Architecture	x86
Configure Command	cscript /nologo configure.js "--enable-snapshot-build" "--disable-isapi" "--enable-debug-p "--without-pdo-mssql" "--without-pi3web" "--with-pdo-oci=c:\php-sdk\oracle\x86\instantclie "--with-oci8-12c=c:\php-sdk\oracle\x86\instantclient_12_1\sdk,shared" "--enable-object-o com-dotnet=shared" "--with-mcrypt=static" "--without-analyzer" "--with-pgo"
Server API	Apache 2.0 Handler
Virtual Directory Support	enabled
Configuration File (php.ini) Path	C:\Windows
Loaded Configuration File	C:\xampp\php5-6-3\php.ini
Scan this dir for additional .ini files	(none)
Additional .ini files parsed	(none)
PHP API	20131106
PHP Extension	20131226